



Learning Space

IAS MAINS 2020

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

CASE STUDIES

MODULE - 7

CASE STUDY - 7

You were posted as Municipal Commissioner in a city with a population of around one million. Just after taking over from your predecessor, an unfortunate incident attracted the eye of the Nation. The incident is narrated here under.

A brother and a sister aged 12 and 10 years were going to school on a bicycle. Suddenly a push-cart, which was used for selling vegetables by the margins of the road, rolled over and hit the children. Both the children fell on the road and were run over by a speedy car, resulting in the loss of precious lives of the children.

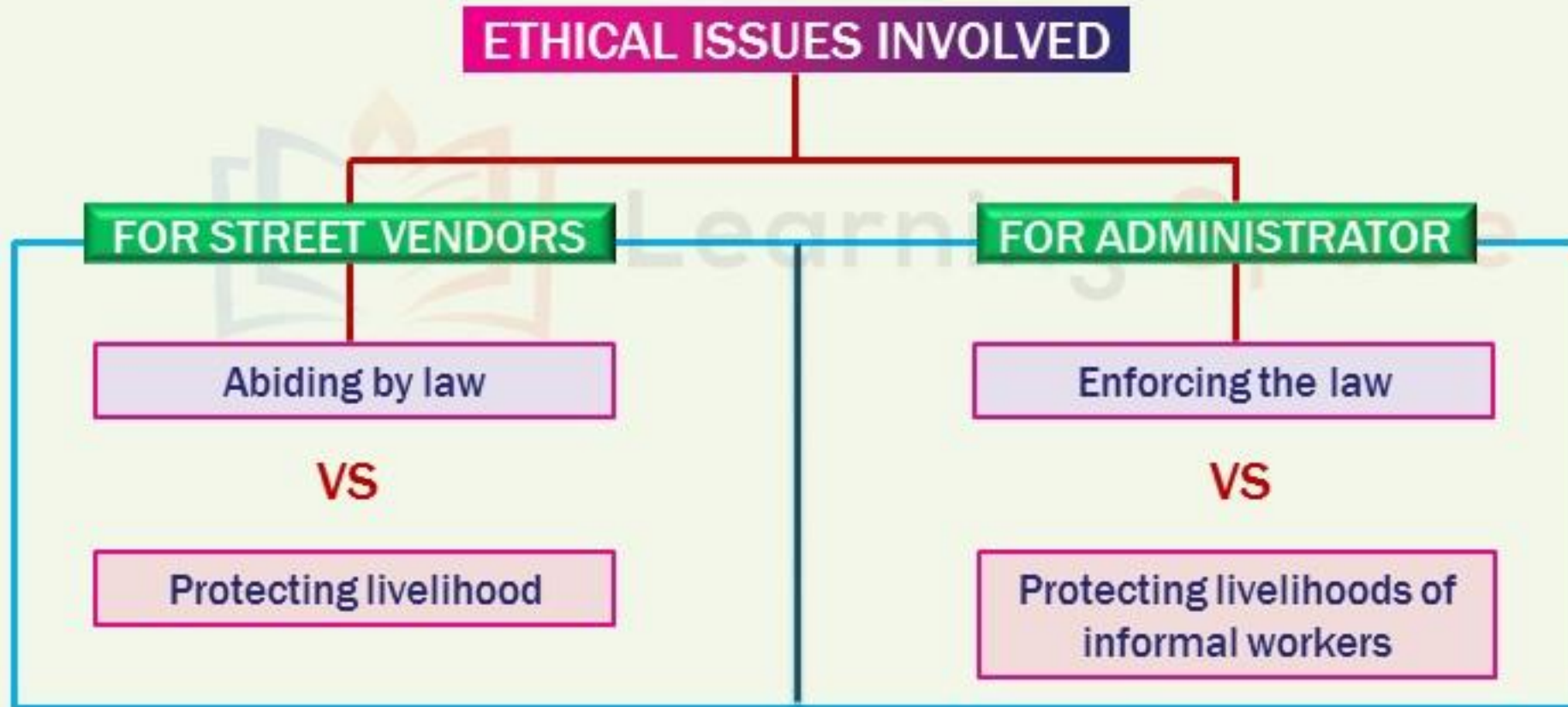
You are nominated as the enquiry officer and the following aspects were revealed during your enquiry.

- 1) A separate complex was made available for the vegetable vendors and a circular was issued two years ago not to allow any push-carts on the margins of the road.
- 2) Several vendors did not move due to two reasons: more business on the road margins; and Rs. 10,000 deposit prescribed by the municipality for occupation in the separate complex.
- 3) Some of the vendors are managing on the busy roads with push-carts alongside and it gave good business to them and in turn they are giving daily bribes to police / municipal officials.

As a responsible civil servant, what measures would take to prevent recurrence of such incidents? Justify your answer. (250 words)

CASE STUDIES

This case narrates the law evading attitudes, mostly out of compulsions, of informal workers to earn livelihood, and consequent adverse impact on common people.



CASE STUDIES

As the municipal commissioner, I would take the following steps:

IMMEDIATE MEASURES

- Release immediate notice to all vendor to clear the road and shift their carts to complex.
- Place a traffic constable in the region to ensure that the vendors don't relapse.
- Take the owner of the cart that hit the bicycle in to custody.
- Place signboard to emphasize on free road margins and CCTVs to monitor.
- Advertise through local and social media to city dwellers about the changes made.
- Enable free flow for city dwellers to reach complex.
- Make city dwellers aware through social media that their participation is necessary to protect livelihoods of vendors and sustain implementing the law.
- Set up grievance redressal cell for vendor who get affected.

LONG TERM MEASURES

- Survey all roads of the city to prevent repetitions of such dangers.
- Monitor strict implementation and progress being achieved.
- Keep updating the citizens about the reduced accidents and progress because of their participation.
- Ensure that the vendors whose livelihood got affected is accommodated in government skilling programme to enable alternate livelihood.

CONCLUSION

Behaviour change and quick redressal of grievance of lower sections of society is necessary for them to follow law and enable strict implementation of law. Participatory governance is the key for success and sustenance of any government policy or programme.

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SINCERE THANKS
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For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

For Information:

info.learningspacedigital@gmail.com

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0866 244 44 72

98499 42299

94415 27588